

Git Diff and Meld on Windows

Asked 12 years, 10 months ago Modified 6 years, 2 months ago



Sign in to Stack Exchange with Google



Maxie Schmidt

maxieds@gmail.com



Maxie Schmidt

maxieds85v2@gmail.com



21



Has anyone ever made Meld work with Git? I have tried but with no success.

I have Meld installed and when I call it from the command line it diffs them well so Meld is installed correctly. However I can't make it work with Git (Git Diff). I use version git version 1.8.1.msysgit.1 of Git.

I have tried several things: I created a shell script, `meld.sh` :

```
#!/bin/bash
meld.exe "$2" "$5"
echo $2
echo $5
```

and used it from Git:

```
[diff]
  tool = meld

[difftool "meld"]
  cmd = "\"D:\\meld.sh\""
```

I tried to add it as a difftool like this:

```
[diff]
  tool = meld

[difftool "meld"]
  cmd = "\"C:\\Program Files (x86)\\Meld\\meld\\meld.exe\""
```

or like this:

```
[diff]
  tool = meld

[difftool "meld"]
  cmd = '\"/c/Program Files (x86)/Meld/meld/meld.exe\" $PWD/$LOCAL $PWD/$BASE $PWD/$REMOTE --output=$PWD/$MERGED'
```

But it really does not seem to work. I also tried to echo the second(\$2) and fifth(\$5) parameter from my shell script and no output. I also tried using a batch script in several ways:

```
meld.exe %2 %5
```

or

```
meld.exe %~2 %~5
```

But it really does not work... How can I pass the two versions of the file `git` uses when diffing to Meld? It's pretty annoying...

[git](#) [msysgit](#) [git-diff](#) [meld](#) [difftool](#)

Share Improve this question Follow

edited Feb 16, 2019 at 9:22

asked Nov 27, 2013 at 9:45



Peter Mortensen

30.8k 22 112 135



Jacob Krieg

3,330 19 84 146

5 Answers

Sorted by: Highest score (default)



Usually, you can find an example on Windows similar to [this gist](#), with `meld.exe` being in your `PATH`):

29



```
git config --global merge.tool meld
git config --global mergetool.meld.cmd 'meld.exe \"$BASE\" \"$LOCAL\" \"$REMOTE\"
\"$MERGED\"'
```



```
git config --global diff.tool meld
git config --global difftool.meld.cmd 'meld.exe \"$LOCAL\" \"$REMOTE\"'
```

+50

You can find more robust settings in "[Git mergetool with Meld on Windows](#)", but the idea remains the same.



The OP reports in the comments:

For the `difftool`, your commands write the following configurations in `.gitconfig`:

```
[diff]
  tool = meld
[difftool "meld"]
  cmd = meld.exe \\\"$LOCAL\\\" \\\"$REMOTE\\\"
```

I changed them to:

```
[diff]
  tool = meld
[difftool "meld"]
  cmd = meld.exe $LOCAL $REMOTE
```

and everything worked fine.

Share Improve this answer Follow

edited Feb 16, 2019 at 9:23

answered Dec 5, 2013 at 13:27



Peter Mortensen

30.8k 22 112 135



VonC

1.4m 570 4.8k 5.8k

8 Comments ^

Add a comment



Jacob Krieg Over a year ago

I tried your method but it does not work properly. Here how it looks like: i.imgur.com/KIaVb04.png. If you have any issues in understanding the paths please let me know, I hid the user name and part of the file name.

▲ 1 Reply ...



Jacob Krieg Over a year ago

Managed to make the `difftool` work. Haven't tried the `mergetool` but chances are that they will work the same. For the `difftool` your commands write the following configurations in `.gitconfig` :

```
[diff] tool = meld [difftool "meld"] cmd = meld.exe \\\"$LOCAL\\\" \\\"$REMOTE\\\"
I changed them to: [diff] tool = meld [difftool "meld"] cmd = meld.exe $LOCAL $REMOTE
and everything worked fine. I will try with mergetool later but I will accept your comment :) Thanks!
```

▲ 0 Reply ...



VonC Over a year ago

@JasonSwartz great. I have included your comment in the answer for more visibility.

▲ 1 Reply ...



Jacob Krieg Over a year ago

I tried `meld` as a `mergetool` and i used the same parameters for `meld` as for the `difftool`: `cmd = meld.exe $LOCAL $REMOTE` and worked wonderful. Otherwise it crashed probably because of the parameters. Thanks, again!

▲ 0 Reply ...



Jason Joslin Over a year ago

removing the quotes on the `$LOCAL` and `$REMOTE` was absolutely key for me. must be like `cmd = meld.exe $LOCAL $REMOTE`

▲ 0 Reply ...



7



Or even better, if you're on a locked-down system where fooling with the path is not allowed or you just don't want to pollute your path space, you can just put in the full path to Meld.

I also prefer my current working code copy to show up on the left, so I swapped the \$REMOTE and \$LOCAL arguments. Also mind the conversions of \ to / and don't forget to escape the double quotes.

```
[diff]
  tool = meld
[difftool "meld"]
  cmd = "\"C:/Program Files (x86)/Meld/meld/meld.exe\" $REMOTE $LOCAL
```

Share Improve this answer Follow

edited Feb 16, 2019 at 9:24

answered Jul 24, 2014 at 20:27



Peter Mortensen

30.8k 22 112 135



mehsin

641 1 7 12

Comments

Add a comment



6



For Windows 7 (or even other versions of windows), add these lines in the .gitconfig file.

```
[diff]
  tool = meld
[merge]
  tool = meld
[difftool "meld"]
  path = C:/Program Files (x86)/Meld/meld.exe
[mergetool "meld"]
  path = C:/Program Files (x86)/Meld/meld.exe
```

Note that there is no need to use " for the path even if it includes spaces. Just remember to use forward slashes instead of backward slashes.

Share Improve this answer Follow

edited Jul 1, 2020 at 10:21

answered Jan 2, 2017 at 7:28



Pierre Gramme

1,254 7 25



Rajeev

71 1 3

4 Comments ^

Add a comment



pperejon Over a year ago

It works in Windows Server 2012 R2 out of the box. Easiest solution found.

▲ 0 Reply ...



navjotjsingh Over a year ago

Doesn't work on Windows 10 with latest versions of GIt and Meld.

▲ 0 Reply ...



Pierre Gramme Over a year ago

Clean solution for both diff and merge, thanks! Minor comment, based on my experience and on all other answers posted here: the default path to Meld rather seems to be `C:/Program Files (x86)/Meld/meld.exe` . I'll propose an edit in the answer

▲ 0 Reply ...



kohane15 Over a year ago

For meld version 3.20.3, the default installation path is

`C:/Users/UserName/AppData/Local/Programs/Meld/Meld.exe` , so the path should be `path = C:/Users/UserName/AppData/Local/Programs/Meld/Meld.exe`

▲ 0 Reply ...



2



I tried several variations of trying to set the path with `git config` to no avail. Since I want to use Meld from the Git Bash console window, what did work was to export the path to the Meld directory, restart the Bash shell and lo & behold `git difftool --tool-help` and `git mergetool --tool-help` now recognize Meld, and I can choose it as my preferred tool.

.profile



```
export PATH=/c/Program\ Files\ \(x86\)/Meld/:$PATH
```

.gitconfig

```
[merge]
  tool = meld
[diff]
  tool = meld
```

Share Improve this answer Follow

edited Feb 16, 2019 at 9:26



Peter Mortensen

30.8k 22 112 135

answered Sep 1, 2017 at 14:59



Cathy

67 3

Comments

Add a comment



Another tip for users invoking diff from gitk (by right-clicking the context menu item "**External Diff**"):

1



The above settings may get overridden by gitk's preferences. In that case, change the tools in gitk's menu *Edit* → *Preferences* → *General* → *External diff* setting.



Share Improve this answer Follow

edited Feb 16, 2019 at 9:28

answered Mar 2, 2018 at 0:27



Peter Mortensen

30.8k 22 112 135



TingQian Li

709 8 13

Comments

Add a comment

Start asking to get answers

Find the answer to your question by asking.

Ask question

Explore related questions

git

msysgit

git-diff

meld

difftool

See similar questions with these tags.